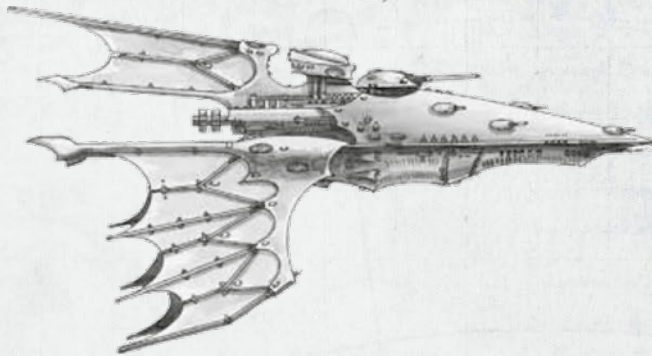


ECLIPSE CLASS CRUISER

Famous Ships of the Gothic War: Silent Warrior, Asuryan's Chosen, Stardeath, Eliarenath's Gift



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Cruiser/6	10/20/25 cm	Special	Holofields	4+	0
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED		FIREPOWER/STR	FIRE ARC
Keel launch bays		Darkstar: 30 cm Eagle: 20 cm		4 squadrons	–
Prow pulsar lance		30 cm		2	Front

The Eclipse is perhaps one of the most effective attack craft carriers in the Gothic sector. While most carrier-type vessels must maintain considerable distance from the enemy, thus increasing the amount of time fighters and bombers spend approaching their target, the Eclipse can deploy its Darkstar fighters and Eagle bombers within striking distance and then use its great speed and agility to withdraw from the firing line. Couple this with the extraordinary proficiency of Eldar attack craft, and it can be seen why Eclipse class cruisers were the bane of Imperial convoy commanders throughout the Gothic sector. In particular, the *Stardeath* caused the destruction of at least fourteen convoys, accounting for over twenty eight merchant and military vessels itself. The *Stardeath* was eventually caught and eliminated by the frigates of the Skargul patrol when its holofields were destroyed by a fortuitous torpedo hit, after a dogged three day chase through the Graildark Nebula. The *Silent Warrior* gained much notoriety in the Port Maw region after the Walpurgis Attack, during which its piratical crew boarded and captured the *Vigilant*, which was on station to escort several Penal Legion transports to the Imperial Guard fighting on Lethe. The Eldar corsairs forced the *Vigilant's* captain to transmit the all-clear signal and as the undefended transports left the planet's atmosphere for the rendezvous, they were mercilessly destroyed by Eagle bombers from the *Silent Warrior's* launch bays.